

# SURREY SCOUT

JANUARY, 1979

No. 380

## County Chairman

May I send, through "Surrey Scout" New Year greetings from my wife and myself to all Scouts, Scouters and Commissioners in Surrey? We would like to express our good wishes for 1979 and in doing so we have very much in mind the continuing benefits of Scouting for boys, young men and young women and also the benefits which these young people will bring increasingly to society at large by the exercise of their skills, experience and sense of commitment acquired through active Scouting.

Inevitably, as County Chairman, my special interest is in the work of the many adult supporters of Scouting in Surrey who are not Scouts, Scouters or Commissioners though many of them have been in the past. To these good friends we also send our greetings and our best wishes in the invaluable work they do — most of it quietly in the background as Committee Members, Treasurers, Secretaries and suppliers of advice and practical help in unlimited forms.

I value the opportunities some of us have of meeting on one Sunday afternoon each year to prepare notes. I refer, of course, to the meeting of District Chairmen, Secretaries and Treasurers which has now become an annual event. I do hope that we shall have our usual good turn-out at the next meeting which is to be at 2.30 p.m. on February 4th. Full details are being circulated by the County Secretary but perhaps I may disclose that, while we propose to retain the principle feature of previous meetings — the separate discussion groups of Chairmen, Secretaries and Treasurers — we also hope to introduce a new method of promoting discussion on ways of increasing the efficient conduct of routine committee and council meetings.

If there is a District Chairman, Secretary or Treasurer who has not attended one of these annual County meetings may I ask her or him to make a special effort to come on February 4th.

Especially I would ask each District to make sure that, in addition to the Chairman, Secretary and

Treasurer, there is also at the meeting, someone to represent public relations. This is a most important aspect and last year not enough District P.R.O.s attended the meeting to justify a Public Relation's discussion group. I do hope there will be more this year — there really ought to be twenty — one from each District.

I look forward to this meeting with pleasurable anticipation and believe it is appropriately a part of the forward-looking philosophy of New Year.

GEOFFREY WRIGHT

## Congratulations

### LONG SERVICE DECORATION

B.R. Fairchild

A.D.C. (C.S.) Horley

### CHIEF SCOUT'S AWARD

Simon Baxter  
David Dennis  
Steven Fox  
David Hersee  
Richard Horley  
Peter Howard  
Julian Kelly  
Christopher King  
Kevin McKee  
Paul Mansell  
Michael O'Driscoll  
Stephen Richardson  
David Roberts  
Ian Roberts  
David Stapleton  
Christopher Stone  
Jeremy Taylor  
David Thoburn  
Stephen Wheddon  
David Wright

1st Weybridge  
14th Epsom (St. Josephs)  
Oatlands  
2nd Cuddington  
1st Cuddington  
Chobham  
17th Reigate  
9th Horley  
17th Reigate  
1st West Byfleet  
17th Reigate  
3rd Banstead  
Chobham  
Chobham  
Chobham  
Chobham  
1st Byfleet  
14th Epsom (St. Josephs)  
17th Reigate  
Oatlands



# County Commissioner

After nearly nine years as District Commissioner for Sunbury and Shepperton, Bob Turner has unfortunately had to resign in view of increased business commitments in Saudi Arabia. We wish him, and his wife Mary, every success as he starts a prolonged tour of office in Jeddah.

In his place I am pleased to announce that Ian Phillpot, whose own business commitments prevented him from taking up the appointment of A.C.C. (Activities) in 1978, has been able to accept my invitation to become District Commissioner for Sunbury and Shepperton. Ian was previously D.C. for Staines and the experience he gained of running that District will be valuable as he takes on his new appointment. We wish him, too, every success.

Although increased business commitments were also the main reason which led to Derek Bassett having to give up his appointment as Assistant County Commissioner (Cub Scouts), as announced in the November issue of *Surrey Scout*, he will be remaining a member of the County Team as A.C.C. (Development). In this role he will be responsible not only for seeking out opportunities for extending Scouting in the Scoutreach sense but, and perhaps more important, for developing Scouting relationships with other organisations and helping to raise the standard of all aspects of Scouting in the County. These are matters which each one of us should be dealing with continually, but in his new appointment Derek will be able to help us focus our thoughts and energy to dealing with the more pressing issues.

I am pleased to announce that Steven Hall has accepted my invitation to become Assistant County Commissioner (Cub Scouts) in succession to Derek Bassett from the end of January. Over the past twelve years, Steve, who lectures at a technical college, has held each of the warranted appointments in the Cub Scout section — A.C.S.L., C.S.L., D.C.S.L., and Assistant District Commissioner (Cub Scouts) in Epsom and Ewell. He therefore brings a wide range of experience to this latest assignment. This is particularly important because the Cub Scout section is the most critical.

The very foundations of a Scouting career are laid in the Cub Scout section. How well those foundations are laid will depend upon the skill and dedication not only of the Cub Scout Leaders — though the brunt of it falls upon them — but also of every single Leader in each Group, backed up by the District and County.

It should be a New Year's resolution for each of us that, whatever our appointment, uniformed or otherwise, we must see to it that the work of the Cub Scout section is fully integrated with that of the others. A Cub Scout Leader left (or allowed) to run the Pack in complete isolation from what is happening

elsewhere in the Group is working at a disadvantage. But, what is worse, this can be detrimental for the Cub Scouts in that Pack.

Just as it is hopeless to lay foundations for a building without regard to the plan for the structure to be erected upon them, so the Cub Scout programme must be planned with a view to the boy's ongoing Scouting career. The Cub Scout Leader must be fully aware of what would be expected of the Cub Scout as he goes up, first into Scouts and then to Venture Scouts. The other side of the coin is that the Scout Leader and Venture Scout Leader for their part must be aware of what foundations are being laid in the Cub Scouts. They have responsibility to help in signing the Cub Scout programme.

Only in those Groups where there is full co-operation and integrated planning between the Sections can the progressive training scheme have the best chances of success. Other things being equal, these are also the Groups where one would expect to find most Queen's Scouts because, as I have constantly pointed out, that should be the goal of every boy joining the Scout Movement.

This need for thorough integration in the Group, places a heavy responsibility on the Group Scout Leader. More and more, it is coming to be appreciated that this is a key appointment in Scouting. All G.S.L.s should ensure that they are fully equipped for the task. They should have a well thumbed copy of that excellent little booklet "The Scout Group" by John Delft which was first published two years ago. It is a mine of information and will amply repay continued study! G.S.L.s should also keep an eye open on articles in "Scouting" which may be of assistance, such as that on "The training role of the G.S.L." in the October 1978 edition. Those holding G.S.L. warrants but who have never done the G.S.L. advanced Training Course should remedy the situation at the earliest opportunity. Courses run by the Surrey/G.L.S.W. joint training team are published regularly in "Surrey Scout". These courses are not only enjoyable but, more to the point, they really do help G.S.L.s to do their job. Be sure to seize the opportunity — and make that another New Year's resolution!

GORDON BATES



## A Very Happy New Year to all our Readers



# Leader Training

Leaders in the County who enjoyed their training during the years up to 1968 will be sorry to learn that 'Paddy' otherwise known as the Reverend Leslie Whitlock, died on 14th November. Paddy retired under the 'age rule' procedures after over 20 years service in the county training team although as a county chaplain he continued to give wise counsel in many group and district situations there after. Amongst his many talents known to his parishioners Paddy was an expert with ropes, tracking and many of the scouting skills which play such an important part of our training programme, we remember him with affection and give thanks for his contribution to scouting in our county.

Set out below are details of the remaining Basic courses this winter and the Advanced courses already

planned. There are not many General Information courses scheduled by Districts. I hope this means that they are not necessary but I have a sneaking feeling that there are quite a lot of people who need them but are not being given the opportunity! It is most important that a G.I. course is completed before the appropriate section Basic course, if you are a leader who wishes to attend any of those set out below contact your A.D.C. (L.T.) immediately if you have not had the chance to attend a G.I.

In this issue space does not permit the inclusion of details of courses in neighbouring counties but if none of ours fit your availabilities then ask your A.D.C. (L.T.) if he can find out, most of them have now established links with our friends next door.

DAVID BARRELL

## Pack Holiday Courses

|               |                      |
|---------------|----------------------|
| Bentley Copse | 31st March/1st April |
| Bentley Copse | 5/6th May            |

## General Information Courses

|          |              |
|----------|--------------|
| Surbiton | 14th January |
| Epsom    | 4th February |

## Basic Courses

### CUB SCOUT LEADER

|             |                                  |
|-------------|----------------------------------|
| Reigate     | 20th/21st January                |
| Teddington  | 28th January and<br>4th February |
| Godalming   | 24th February and<br>10th March  |
| Epsom/Ewell | 25/26th February                 |
| Croydon     | 17/18th March                    |
| Woking      | 7/8th April                      |

### SCOUT LEADERS

|           |                                   |
|-----------|-----------------------------------|
| Godalming | 27th January and<br>10th February |
| Kingston  | 24/25th February                  |

### VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

|               |               |
|---------------|---------------|
| Bentley Copse | 17/18th March |
|---------------|---------------|

### GROUP SCOUT LEADERS

|        |                  |
|--------|------------------|
| Sutton | 17/18th February |
|--------|------------------|

## Advanced Courses

### CUB SCOUT LEADERS

|               |                       |
|---------------|-----------------------|
| Bentley Copse | 18/20th & 26/28th May |
|---------------|-----------------------|

### SCOUT LEADERS

|               |                                         |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Bentley Copse | 8/9th, 15/16th and<br>29/30th September |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------|

### VENTURE SCOUT LEADERS

|               |                                          |
|---------------|------------------------------------------|
| Bentley Copse | 22/23rd September and<br>20/21st October |
|---------------|------------------------------------------|

### GROUP SCOUT LEADERS & COMMISSIONERS

Autumn/Winter 1979

(during this course, the whole of the Wood Badge will be completed as an integral part, details will be announced after completion of the G.S.L. Basic in February. Names of interested leaders can be sent to D.R. Barrell now and they will be kept informed on developments).

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.  
Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

D. Whiteman, 38 Effingham Road, Long Ditton.  
H. Laing, 45 Meadowview Road, West Ewell.

R. Penfold, 49 Wolverton Gardens, Horley.  
S. Street, 15 Summerville Gardens, Cheam.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

D. Brown, 21 Langsmead, Blindly Heath.  
Mrs. M. Walden, 31 Langton Way, Croydon.  
F. Fentiman, "Woodside", Meadow Way, Gt. Bookham

J.M. Elliot, 22 Parkway, Ratton Manor, Eastbourne, Sussex.  
D. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

B.C. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

E.J. Walden, 31 Langton Way, Croydon.

Mrs. W. Viner, 58 West Bank, Dorking.

D.W. Barker, 3 Oriental Close, Woking.

B.C. Wood, 36 Sole Farm Road, Gt. Bookham.

D.R. Barrell, 1 Beech Road, Reigate.



# Venture Scouts

## Field Commissioners' Report.

Every year the Field Commissioners report to the Committee of the Council on the successes and failures of Scouting within their own area. These reports are then summarised and circulated throughout the Movement in the hope that they will promote discussion and action. I wonder how often these reports actually filter down to the training sections. I think that the summary for the Venture Scout Section is very relevant to the Venture Scouting in our County so take the opportunity to reprint it in full in the hope that everyone will find it interesting at least.

"There is evidence that the Section is now making progress. Not only are numbers slowly improving but so are the numbers of Awards being gained. The retention of a greater number of older Venture Scouts is reported in some areas and there has been an encouraging increase of Units in some rural areas. Contrary to the expectations of some people, the increase in overall numbers has not been solely, nor even largely, due to the advent of girl Venture Scouts, the proportion of which remains small. Where a Unit has a mixed membership, however, there is almost universal evidence that standards of training, smartness and behaviour improve.

"Room for improvement is reported in the links

between Troops and Units. Although there is evidence of an increasing number of Group Units as opposed to local Venture Scout Units, too many operate in isolation. Indeed this isolation includes operating without contact with other Units either and it is suggested that the appointment of many more Assistant District Commissioners (Venture Scouts) would be helpful to encourage this co-operation. Such appointments are not easy to fill and in the meantime there would appear to be a need for Counties to provide strong support until Districts can supply their own help in this way.

"Some imaginative and rewarding service projects have been carried out especially among the underprivileged, senior citizens, handicapped folk, hospitals and childrens' homes."

## "Opportunities".

This is the title of a publication by the Youth and Community Service of Surrey County Council. It is full of information on courses, conferences and competitions available to young people in the County. I feel sure this book could help many an Executive Committee when they are programme planning. If you have not got a copy in your Unit may I suggest you apply to your local Youth Office.

BRUCE WOOD

## Scout Fellowship

I returned from the recent National Conference of A.C.C.s (Scout Fellowship) both elated and depressed. Elated, because nationally, the Fellowship is making great progress in all areas; membership, involvement, fields of service, etc. Depressed from the awareness that we, in Surrey, have stood still. Twelve months ago we were one of the foremost counties promoting the Scout Fellowship, now we have been bypassed by nearly half of those Counties represented at the Conference.

In Surrey, I feel that many Districts do not realise the full potential available from the Fellowship which can help provide better Scouting in their areas. Some of those Districts which have Fellowships, do not use the members to the full and a list of possible involvements appears in the Scout Fellowship booklet (price 10p from a branch of the Scout Shop) - All District Officials and Scouters should read it.

It is most noticeable that the Districts where the Fellowship is weakest are those that are not represented at the County Sub-Committee meetings where there is always a full discussion on common problems, recruitment, activity ideas, etc.

For 1979, may I suggest that each District Commissioner with his District Executive, sets out a list of aims for the year and reviews the list in twelve

months time to see what has been achieved. As far as the Scout Fellowship is concerned, here are a few suggestions: Ensure the appointment of a good committed A.D.C. or Fellowship Chairman. Detail a list of jobs and projects for the Fellowship which will help the District to be better and more efficient. Ensure that the Fellowship is an attractive proposition to the elder Venture Scout so he will want to join to continue his involvement in Scouting. Ensure that the Fellowship is represented in all meetings of District Scouters and the District Executive. Make the A.D.C. or Fellowship Chairman a FULL member of the District Team. Increase the Fellowship membership by at least 20%, and if there is no Fellowship at the moment, start one. In this respect as with all others, I will be pleased to help. Ensure that the District is represented at future County Sub-Committee Meetings, the dates of which appear under "County Diary".

Please book 15th-17th July 1979 for the National Scout Fellowship Camp at Gilwell, a great time is promised. The Fellowship Chalet at Gilwell is available for members' use throughout the year and I have full details for those interested.

Ann, Andrew and Kathryn join me in wishing you all a Happy and Peaceful New Year.

ERIC MACKIE



# Water Activities

## New Arrangments for Boat Inspections

1. Group to contact Boat Inspector (names and addresses to be supplied) to inspect boats within his capability. Not all Inspectors can inspect all types of craft.
2. At the inspection the Groups' copy of forms to be produced and heading is copied onto Inspector's report, which is made out in triplicate by hand.
3. Those 3 copies are then distributed so:— (i) and (ii) by Boat Inspector (iii) by Group.
  - i) to Group concerned — immediately they have note of any defects, or conditions required.
  - ii) To Chief Examiner for comments and approval, then to be forwarded to County Registrar.
  - iii) To District Registrar to file and note renewal date.
4. A self-adhesive label will be attached to each boat passed by the Inspector, which shows the year and boat certificate number. These will cost the Group 10p each to be paid to the Boat Inspector.

## NOTES

1. District Registrar can advise G.S.L.s when boats require inspection, as County Registrar had done so previously, normally a month before date of expiry.
2. Copies of boat certificates will not be sent to D.C.s except when a boat is banned or otherwise by default. D.C.s will also annually receive a list of certified boats by Group for their District.
3. Boat Inspectors to fill in forms in block capitals as these will be the only copies — no typing will be required and this should speed the rate inspection forms circulate.
4. An unregistered boat will be inspected as previously stated, on an inspector's report, single sheet which is first sent to the Chief Examiner for approval and forwarded to the County Registrar. Here it is registered, given a certificate number and three copies made.

One copy is sent to G.S.L. with the self-adhesive label to be attached to the boat concerned, one copy sent to District Registrar and one copy filed by County Registrar. This should enable the Group, the District and the County to have a record of that Group's boats.

RICHARD HOLLEY  
Chief Examiner

The following letter has been received which we are pleased to publish:

Dear Scouter

By the time you receive this note I shall be sunning myself in Napier (next to Hastings) New Zealand!

It was indeed very kind of you to contribute to a presentation to me of a crystal glass decanter, sherry glasses and a silver tray and these I shall always cherish.

I was very loath to give up being Registrar but the amount of detailed work involved has grown so much over the years.

I hope that my successors (all 22 of them ! ) will get the co-operation that I have received from you over the years.

Again, very many thanks, and may the Surrey and G.L.S.W. Water Activities continue to flourish.

Yours very sincerely,  
FLORRIE PETERS.

## County Chaplain

Barry Anderson and I are very glad to have Keith Huxley joining us in the County Chaplaincy team. Keith will be taking Peter Fisher's place as the Anglican Chaplain, and while wishing Peter well in his new appointment in Lincoln we welcome Keith very warmly.

Back in the summer we invited each District to nominate one or two ministers or clergymen to share in the Chaplaincy consultation at Bentley Copse. We had a great day together, though not as many Chaplains came as we hoped for.

Although we enjoyed ourselves, it was clear there are some tensions and misunderstandings between the Church and the Scout movement. This is sad because each needs the other.

We want to follow-up our session at Bentley with get-togethers for Scout Leaders and Clergy in each District of the County. We shall plan these as occasions when we can plan more clearly how we can work together. But we need your invitation if we are to set such a meeting up in your District!

In addition to this, during this year we plan a Workshop on Scouts' Owns on 12th May, and another session for Chaplains at Bentley Copse during the afternoon of 20th June.

Sorry if this doesn't provide the usual material for Scouts' Owns this month, but it does need your action because we want every Group in the County to be involved in one way or another in what we plan.

MICHAEL MEECH



# Scouts

My apologies for not making a contribution in last month's "Surrey Scout" for the Scout Section, but I was out of action due to illness at the key period when the Editor required his copy! Apologies also to those who were expecting me at meetings and events during my "time out".

As we embark upon 1979 I hope the Scout Section in the County will feel this to be a special year. Certainly with "SCOUTOUT 79" due to take place at Rushmoor Arena on 13th-15th July we shall certainly be very much in evidence. Planning is proceeding well, and I should like to thank the five Patrols who entered the badge design competition. We are costing some of the designs at the moment and will hope to announce the competition winner before long.

I hope you have all seen the first SCOUTOUT publicity poster which was issued to Districts last September. Further publicity will be out this month, including booking information. I hope the date is firmly noted in your Troop diary.

You will have noticed in past issues of "Scouting" magazine that a Chief Scout's Award Field Test has been running for some time and that it is due to run through until 30th June 1979. A number of Troops in our County have shown an interest in the Field Test, and Surrey Heath District is our main participant. At the last presentation of Chief Scout's Award Certificates one of the Surrey Heath Scouts who came forward had accomplished the Award under the Field Test conditions. As this is an important development for the Scout Section I summarise below the main features, and you will soon see how it differs from the present scheme.

- a) The Award is presented by the District Commissioner on the recommendation of the Patrol Leaders' Council.
- b) The requirements can be attempted by any Scout, aged 14 years and over. A Scout need not have gained any other badges before attempting the Award.
- c) Each Scout should read and think about requirements first, then talk with his Patrol Leaders' Council about what he plans to do. The Award is intended to be a personal challenge.
- d) The Patrol Leaders' Council, with help from the adult leaders, will set the standards of the Award.
- e) Involve other people as much as possible when carrying out the Award, particularly other Scouts in the Patrol, Venture Scouts and Girl Guides.
- f) All sections should be attempted although it is possible to attempt more than one section of the Award in any one activity.

All our participating Troops in the Field Test will, at the end of the test period, report upon the

way in which the Field Test has proceeded, and a full evaluation will then be carried out by the National Scout Board in order to see if changes should be made to the Chief Scout's Award in the future. I will obviously try to keep you informed of progress.

JIM ELLIOT

## Bentley Copse

All leaders should note that the whole of the campsite and training area is already fully booked for some weeks in 1979 and particularly the week from 28th July to 5th August when there will not even be space for casual overnight hike camp book. Don't let your boys be misled into thinking that they can find space at this time.

## County Diary

### January

|    |                         |             |
|----|-------------------------|-------------|
| 8  | Scout Sub-Committee     | Leatherhead |
| 31 | Cub Scout Sub-Committee | Leatherhead |

### February

|    |                                  |             |
|----|----------------------------------|-------------|
| 4  | District Officials' Meeting      |             |
| 17 | Chief Scout's Award Presentation | Reigate     |
| 25 | Scout First Aid Competition      | East Surrey |
| 28 | Fellowship Sub-Committee         | Ewell       |

### April

|   |                         |             |
|---|-------------------------|-------------|
| 2 | Scout Sub-Committee     | Leatherhead |
| 5 | Cub Scout Sub-Committee | Leatherhead |

### May

|    |                          |       |
|----|--------------------------|-------|
| 30 | Fellowship Sub-Committee | Ewell |
|----|--------------------------|-------|

### June

|   |                                  |         |
|---|----------------------------------|---------|
| 9 | Chief Scout's Award Presentation | Sunbury |
|---|----------------------------------|---------|

### July

|       |                     |                |
|-------|---------------------|----------------|
| 2     | Scout Sub-Committee |                |
| 13/15 | Scoutout '79        | Rushmoor Arena |

### September

|       |                                    |               |
|-------|------------------------------------|---------------|
| 29/30 | Scout Patrol & Camping Competition | Bentley Copse |
|-------|------------------------------------|---------------|

### October

|   |                         |             |
|---|-------------------------|-------------|
| 4 | Cub Scout Sub-Committee | Leatherhead |
|---|-------------------------|-------------|

### February "Surrey Scout"

|              |                     |
|--------------|---------------------|
| Copy Date    | Friday 12th January |
| Distribution | Sunday 28th January |